



Fitting in

- 1** How much do you agree with the sentences (1 = completely disagree; 5 = completely agree)?
- Peer pressure is always bad.
 - Great leaders rarely follow the crowd.
 - Conformists are boring.
 - Rebels are usually dangerous.
 - Standing out in a crowd is a bad thing.
 - Everyone should do their own thing sometimes and enjoy being an outsider.
- 2** Choose the correct words to complete the text.

THE GENIUS OF DOING YOUR OWN THING



All of us, but especially teens, often feel ¹... pressure – that feeling that we should ²... the crowd, do what everyone else is doing, and try not to be different. It can feel difficult to ³... out in a crowd, to be the only one who looks, thinks, or feels a certain way. However, while it isn't easy being ⁴... , you are not alone in the world. When you ⁵... against everyone around you, you have something in ⁶... with many great thinkers, including the scientific genius Albert Einstein. While he was able to work with others well and share his ideas, he didn't always ⁷... to their ideas of science or how a scientist should behave. He didn't always follow the rules – he was not ⁸... , and he didn't try to be like anyone but himself. So, go ahead – ⁹... your own thing and fit in with Einstein. You may be on the road to greatness!

- | | | |
|------------------|----------------|-----------|
| 1 a rebel | b peer | c common |
| 2 a follow | b stand | c conform |
| 3 a have | b be | c stand |
| 4 a a conformist | b an outsider | c a rebel |
| 5 a rebel | b conform | c are |
| 6 a common | b pressure | c crowd |
| 7 a follow | b conform | c be |
| 8 a a crowd | b a conformist | c a rebel |
| 9 a have | b be | c do |

Forming nouns from verbs

- 3** Complete the text with the correct form (verb or noun) of the verbs in parentheses.

What we can learn from *Stella Young*

Because she looked so different from most people, Stella Young's ¹... (appear) often caused a ²... (react). She was a wheelchair user, weighed about 40 kilograms, and though she was an adult, she was the size of a child. She spent her career as a writer and comedian trying to help people ³... (understand) disability. She noticed from a young age that people would ⁴... (treat) her differently – speak more loudly to her, for example, as though being in a wheelchair made hearing difficult – it didn't. And people would look at her with an ⁵... (express) of sadness, when she herself felt that she had a great life.



- 4** Complete the text with the correct form (verb or noun) of the words below.

appear express practice react treat understand

How we read each other's emotions

When you feel emotion, your face ¹... . You can ²... trying to hide your feelings, but it's almost impossible to stop the smile that ³... in your eyes, even if your mouth and lips don't show it. And this is important, because the way we ⁴... one another when we interact is based partly on the emotion that we read on others' faces. But what emotions can faces show? Scientific ⁵... is improving constantly. Scientists believe that the ⁶... on your face could indicate one of four emotions: happiness, sadness, fear, or anger.